Where should a banking CX team investigate first?

Analysis of **84,195 unique checking/savings account complaints** received during 2025, using a public CFPB snapshot. Objective: prioritize investigation, not rank banks or estimate population-wide customer satisfaction.

1. Account management dominates the complaint mix

44,959 complaints (53.4%) concern “Managing an account.” Low-funds issues contribute 11,939 (14.2%); closing an account contributes 10,178 (12.1%). Together these represent 79.7% of the cohort.

Recommended action: examine account-management sub-issues and journey steps before allocating improvement resources. Combine these signals with internal contact volumes. Measure issue share, complaints per account/transaction, and repeat contacts after changes.

2. January needs validation before interpretation

18,367 complaints were received in January; 4,144 occurred on January 17. Two companies account for 12,170 January records (66.3%). These concentrations suggest investigating event, reporting, or intake effects; they do not establish a cause.

Recommended action: inspect sub-issues, dates, and source history, then assess whether the spike represents a distinct episode. December reached 7,692 complaints, up 26.6% from November; investigate mix changes before interpreting that increase.

3. Response timeliness is high, but does not measure satisfaction

99.3% timely response among records with Yes/No values. A timely reply can still leave a problem unresolved. Response-category distributions add context but do not measure customer satisfaction.

Recommended action: combine this dashboard with internal time-to-resolution, repeat-contact, and survey measures. Set baselines first; evaluate intervention outcomes using appropriate denominators and comparison periods.

Method & limits

Python parsed dates, checked IDs, enforced cohort scope, and loaded SQLite. SQL aggregates were reconciled against independently counted rows. 84,348 downloaded records; 153 excluded; 0 duplicate IDs. Dashboard filters operate on aggregate cells. Public complaints are self-selected, may reflect reporting practices, and lack bank customer denominators. No NPS, CSAT, NLP, causal effects, or achieved business improvement is claimed.

Source: CFPB Consumer Complaint Database, downloaded October 14, 2026. Snapshot and reproducible code included with the project.